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2D Platformer GDD

Project Info

Game Title: That Time I Almost Turned Into A Slime

Author/Team: Angel Disney Aragones

Platform(s): PC (Windows)

Engine/Tools: Unity 2D, Visual Studio / VS Code, Git for version control

Game Overview and Vision

High Concept:

A 2D platformer where the player must escape a dangerous dungeon while slowly transforming into a slime, using movement, jumping, and enemy interaction to survive.

Game Summary:

The player wakes up inside a mysterious dungeon after being exposed to a strange magical substance that is gradually turning them into a slime. To escape, the player must navigate through multiple levels filled with traps, enemies, and environmental hazards. Along the way, the player must avoid danger, defeat enemies by jumping on them, and reach the exit of each level.

Player Journey Snapshot:

The player begins confused and weak, learning basic movement and survival. As they progress, they encounter more difficult obstacles and enemies, requiring better timing and control. By the end, the player becomes more skilled and confident, overcoming increasingly dangerous sections of the dungeon.

Unique Selling Point:

The combination of classic platformer mechanics (like jumping on enemies) with the theme of slowly transforming into a slime creates a unique narrative and gameplay experience.

Target Audience:

- Fans of 2D platformers

- Casual to intermediate players
- cozy gamers

Genre & Inspirations:

- Genre: 2D Platformer
- mario-style games
- castle crashers

Artistic and Emotional Tone:

The game has a slightly mysterious and tense tone at the start, but becomes more adventurous as the player progresses. The environment is dark and dungeon-like.

Core Gameplay Design**Core Gameplay Loop:**

1. Player moves through the level
2. Avoids traps and hazards
3. collects coins and hidden treasures
4. Defeats enemies by jumping on them
5. Navigates platforming challenges
6. Reaches the end of the level
7. Progresses to a more difficult level

Player Progression:

Progression is based on level advancement and collecting coins to later on buy armor or weapons at a safe zone

Controls & Input:

- Move Left/Right: A / D or Arrow Keys
- Jump: Spacebar
- Climb Ladder: W / S or Up / Down Arrow

Difficulty & Challenge:

- early levels introduce basic mechanics
- later levels require precision timing and better movement control
- hazards become more frequent and punishing
- only 3 lives per level

Feedback Systems:

- Visual feedback through animations (jumping, climbing, death)
- Immediate response to player input
- Death animation when hitting hazards
- Enemy defeat feedback when jumped on

Game Mechanics & Systems**Core Mechanics:**

- Running and jumping
- Climbing ladders
- Enemy interaction (jumping on enemies to defeat them)
- Hazard avoidance (spikes, traps)

Side Mechanics:

- Environmental navigation (platforms, gaps, vertical movement)
- Level exploration

Interaction Mechanics:

- Player vs Enemy: jumping on enemies defeats them
- Player vs Hazard: touching hazards results in death
- Player vs Environment: platforms and ladders enable movement

Economy & Resources:

The game includes a simple resource system based on collectible coins. Coins are scattered throughout levels and can be collected by the player during exploration. Coins will be used to purchase antidotes to slow or reverse the slime transformation, weapons or upgrades to improve survivability, and armor to reduce damage from hazards or enemies

Narrative, World, & Characters**Themes & Emotional Arc:**

The player begins confused and vulnerable inside a mysterious dungeon but gradually becomes more confident while navigating traps and enemies.

Story Overview:

The player wakes up inside a strange dungeon after being exposed to a magical substance that is slowly turning them into a slime. The player must navigate multiple dungeon floors filled with traps, enemies, and environmental challenges. As the player progresses deeper through the dungeon, they uncover clues about the origin of the strange magic and the creatures that inhabit the dungeon.

World Building:

The game takes place in an ancient underground dungeon made up of multiple chambers, corridors, and hidden rooms. The dungeon contains traps, slime creatures, and remnants of past explorers who failed to escape. Each level represents a deeper or more dangerous section of the dungeon with increasing hazards and obstacles.

Main Characters:

- Player Character: A human who is slowly transforming into a slime due to magical exposure
- Enemies: Slime creatures and other dungeon hazards

Player Agency:

The player controls movement, jumping, climbing, and how they approach obstacles and enemies. Success depends on player skill, timing, and decision-making.

Level & Encounter Design:**Objectives:**

The primary objective in each level is to survive and reach the exit.

Structure & Layout:

Horizontal progression with platforms and gaps, vertical sections using ladders, and occasional branching paths for optional exploration (coins or secrets)

Gameplay Flow:

Introduction → Simple platforms to get the player moving

Challenge Build-Up → Introduces new enemies, platforms, or hazards not previously shown yet

Increased Difficulty → Combines movement + enemies + traps

Peak Challenge → Most difficult section of the level

Resolution → Door leading to the next level, final door leads to a safe area

Interactive Elements:

Ladders, platforms, enemies, and hazards such as spikes on the ground.

Progression Gates:

Player skill (timing, movement, precision) and increasing difficulty of level design. Future systems may include acquiring keys to open a section of the level and also shops requiring coins for upgrades.

Environmental Storytelling:

As the player progresses deeper, the environment becomes more corrupted, hinting at the source of the slime transformation.

UI, UX, & Accessibility**Core UI Elements:**

Coin counter, possible health or status indicator, minimal UI to avoid clutter

Menus & Screens:

- Main Menu (Play, Quit)
- Pause Menu (Resume, Quit)

HUD Design:

Coin count displayed during gameplay as well as lives left.

UX Flow:

1. Player starts at Main Menu
2. Selects Play → enters game
3. Plays through levels
4. On death, prompts the Game Over menu with the option to restart the game or exit the game.
5. After completing level 3, it prompts the Win menu with the option to restart the game or exit the game.

Onboarding:

The game teaches mechanics through gameplay rather than long tutorials:

Accessibility Options:

Simple and intuitive controls and clear visual feedback